

very good resources for finding all the good ones in one place. The top sites that sweepers use are Online-Sweepstakes.com and SweepsAdvantage.com. Both are very good resources with different formats. Other places to find sweepstakes are in magazines, email newsletters, grocery stores (the liquor aisles usually have many), and local radio stations.

HOW DO I GET STARTED?

While all you really need to get started is a computer and some extra time, there are some tricks of the trade that you should know. First, get a separate email for your sweepstakes entries. While the chances of spam aren't too much greater (assuming you are only entering legitimate sweepstakes), you will receive some sponsor newsletters as a condition for entry into some of the better sweepstakes. You really don't want that cluttering up your work or personal inbox. Also, make sure you have a physical mailing address set up for your entries. Some prize fulfillment companies do not ship to P.O. boxes, as they want to enforce "one prize per household" rules.

WHAT TOOLS WILL I NEED?

I'm a big fan of the Firefox Web browser (Firefox.com) with the Fasterfox add-on (Fasterfox.mozdev.org). This saves my pages for quick

viewing later, and if you are entering some of the same sweepstakes daily, this will save you time. (Just be sure to clear everything weekly or more to avoid PC clutter and security issues.) Also, I have been using the free version of RoboForm (RoboForm.com) for filling out all of my forms quickly. This doesn't violate the terms of most sweepstakes regulations which prohibit automated entry, as you are manually entering the contest by loading the page and hitting submit.

HOW DO YOU HAVE TIME TO DO THIS?

I make time. Seriously, like anything else, I maximize time spent entering to get the biggest bang for my buck. I only enter for things I want, need, or can sell for a nice chunk of cash. I spend 30–45 minutes a day during my morning coffee or an afternoon snack entering the sweepstakes that are ending the next day, and I sometimes glance through the instant wins for things I really want. By being selective but persistent, I have a good chance of getting in entries and not ending up with some junky prize that I have to make room for later.

HOW LONG BEFORE I WIN SOMETHING?

I don't know. But I will say that as a general rule, it will take at least six